

THE SOCIAL UNIVERSE (TSU)

Family of the Core Seven

Status: Open. Marc-Anthony's immediate family (Natasha, Robert, Victor, Joan) and future children (Emma, Victoria) were established in the original source material — now written out in full below as **The Bullock Family**, the same format as the other six, so the whole ensemble is visible in one place. This doc builds out family for all seven core cast members, sized to complement (and occasionally complicate) what's already established about each of them.

Companion docs: TSU_Core_Cast.md · TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md · TSU_Historical_Context.md · TSU_Continuity_Bible.md

THE BULLOCK FAMILY

Marc-Anthony's people. Three generations of Hollywood dynasty, the load-bearing family of the entire franchise — per the Historical Context doc, the Donohue lineage is TSU's founding divergence, the reason this kind of compounding Black entertainment-industry wealth exists two generations before it became common. Every other family in this document is built in some kind of contrast to this one.

Residences (locked): Victor and Joan live at **the Donohue Estate**. Marc-Anthony, Natasha, Robert, and their children (Grace, and Elxa until she moved out) live at **the Bullock Estate** — a separate residence. Any scene set at Victor or Joan's home uses DONOHUE ESTATE; any scene set at Marc-Anthony's family home uses BULLOCK ESTATE. Do not conflate the two.

VICTOR DONOHUE

Born: May 30, 1936. Marc-Anthony's grandfather (maternal). **Wife:** Joan Mercer, m. 1960. **Home:** The Donohue Estate. A respected, powerful, and insanely wealthy award-winning actor, singer, producer, and director — a billionaire, and the founding patriarch of the entire Bullock/Donohue dynasty. Per the Historical Context doc, Victor is TSU's version of "The Donohue Breakthrough" made flesh: one of the first Black entertainers of his generation to acquire real points, publishing rights, and equity in his own work, at a moment when the real industry offered almost no Black performers any ownership at all. That first deal, decades ago, is the seed every dollar in this family's current fortune grew from. By 2004 he's an industry elder statesman — the kind of legend whose mere presence at an event becomes the headline. He is fiercely, unsentimentally proud of Marc-Anthony, and the two have a relationship built on mutual recognition: Victor sees his own younger self's hunger in his grandson, tempered by a warmth Victor himself never fully had room for while he was busy prying doors open.

JOAN DONOHUE (née Mercer)

Born: April 17, 1938. Marc-Anthony's grandmother (maternal). **Husband:** Victor Donohue, m. 1960. **Home:** The Donohue Estate. Respected, powerful, and insanely wealthy in her own right — an award-winning actress, singer, director, and filmmaker, not merely "Victor's wife" in any sense the family or the industry would ever tolerate. Where Victor broke ground on ownership, Joan broke ground behind the camera, directing projects at a time when almost no women — let alone Black women — were given

that chance. She is the Bullock family's emotional center in a way Victor, for all his power, has never quite managed to be; she's the one who actually remembers everyone's birthday, who calls Marc-Anthony weekly just to talk about nothing in particular. Marc-Anthony's own instinct for warmth and remembering small details about the people he loves is, by the family's own private consensus, inherited directly from Joan.

NATASHA BULLOCK (née Donohue)

Born: June 2, 1961. Marc-Anthony's mother. Only daughter of Victor and Joan. **Husband:** Robert Bullock, m. 1981. **Home:** The Bullock Estate. A respected and powerful, award-winning, critically acclaimed actress and singer in her own right — and, on top of that entire career, her children's manager. Per the Historical Context doc's "Salon Wars" framing, Natasha built and held her own independent management company through a 1990s wave of industry consolidation that folded most of her competitors into larger agencies; she's one of the rare survivors, and that survival is a point of real pride for her. Managing her own children professionally means she carries two identities at once inside every negotiation on their behalf — mother and executive — and she has never once let either one fully override the other, a balancing act the rest of the industry watches with a mix of admiration and disbelief. Her relationship with Dr. Vivian Smiley (Esther's mother) is one of professional respect layered with real philosophical disagreement about how child performers should be raised — the two women have been circling the same argument for over a decade.

ROBERT BULLOCK

Born: February 10, 1959. Marc-Anthony's father. **Wife:** Natasha Donohue, m. 1981. A respected and powerful, award-winning, critically acclaimed director and filmmaker — a formidable career entirely his own, separate from the Donohue name he married into, which matters enormously to how he carries himself in a dynasty this large. Robert is the family's quiet counterweight to the Donohue side's outsized presence: less publicly larger-than-life than Victor, but arguably just as respected within the industry for the precision and craft of his own work. He's the parent Marc-Anthony goes to specifically for creative and professional judgment — where Natasha manages the business of her son's career, Robert is the one who actually talks him through a role, a scene, a choice. Notably shares a birthday (February 10) with Amond Baker, a coincidence the two families have joked about for years.

ELXA BULLOCK

Born: August 29, 1980. Marc-Anthony's older sister. Eldest child of Natasha and Robert. Granddaughter of Victor and Joan. An award-winning actress and television personality in her own right, and the only member of the immediate Bullock siblings older than Marc-Anthony — which gave her a specific, formative role growing up as the one who went first, absorbing the industry's sharpest edges a couple of years before her younger brother had to face them himself. She and Marc-Anthony are close in the unshowy way siblings who grew up genuinely liking each other often are; she's protective of him without hovering, and she was, by family account, the first person outside their parents to recognize just how unusually gifted he was as a small child.

GRACE BULLOCK

Born: April 12, 1984. Marc-Anthony's younger sister. Youngest child of Natasha and Robert. Granddaughter of Victor and Joan. An award-winning actress and singer specializing in musical theatre,

and the sibling with the single closest bond to Marc-Anthony of anyone in the family, full stop — described, per the source material, as ride-or-die to a genuinely alarming degree ("she would literally hide a body for him"). Where Elxa's closeness to Marc-Anthony is steady and unshowy, Grace's is fierce and vocal — she's the sibling most likely to publicly, loudly defend him without waiting to hear the other side of a story first, a loyalty that occasionally worries the rest of the family a little and delights Marc-Anthony without fail.

EMMA BULLOCK

Born: May 10, 2012. Marc-Anthony's daughter with Esther Smiley. Older twin, by 25 minutes. A thousand-percent daddy's girl, spoiled by Marc-Anthony endlessly and yet — per the source material — still genuinely respectful and responsible, having absorbed the real meaning of hard work despite the spoiling. Described as Marc-Anthony's literal twin in personality and talent: nearly everything about who she is traces directly back to him.

VICTORIA BULLOCK

Born: May 10, 2012. Marc-Anthony's daughter with Esther Smiley. Younger twin. Also a thousand-percent daddy's girl, also spoiled endlessly, also respectful and responsible underneath it — but where Emma is Marc-Anthony's steady mirror, Victoria is his contained wild card: a genuine wild child, just one who somehow always keeps it within bounds. Like Emma, nearly all of her talent and personality is inherited from her father.

Pregnancy timeline (locked, realistic dating): Twins are almost never full-term — the real-world average gestational age at delivery is about 36 weeks, versus ~40 for a singleton. Counting back 36 weeks from Emma and Victoria's May 10, 2012 birth puts conception at **approximately September 15, 2011** (LMP around September 1, 2011, plus the standard ~2-week gap to ovulation/conception). This lands squarely inside the locked "together 2011" window for Marc-Anthony and Esther (TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §4) — specifically the night dramatized in `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md`, scene 32 (EXT. MARC-ANTHONY'S HOUSE — NIGHT, SEPTEMBER 2011), the first night they stop being "just friends." Not a coincidence the film left open; it's now the canon reading of that scene. A realistic range if delivery fell anywhere from 34–38 weeks instead of exactly 36 puts conception between late August and late September 2011 — September 15 is the locked best estimate, not a hard boundary.

Note: Lyric Baker (b. April 20, 2014, daughter of Amond Baker and Harmony Divine) is not a Bullock by blood, but Marc-Anthony is her godfather — see The Baker Family below for her entry.

THE BAKER FAMILY

Amond's people. Where the Bullocks are Hollywood dynasty, the Bakers are working-class Los Angeles — which is exactly the contrast that makes Amond's "came up through grit, not legacy" characterization land.

GLORIA BAKER (née Ferris)

Amond's mother — ran a hair salon in Inglewood for over two decades, the kind of neighborhood institution where half the block's business gossip actually happened in her chair. She's the reason Amond

has the guardedness and loyalty he's known for: she raised him largely alone after his father left when he was six, and she did it by being fiercely protective and unsentimental in equal measure. She was suspicious of the entertainment industry from the moment an agent first approached her about her son — not because she doubted his talent, but because she'd watched enough of her clients' kids get chewed up by it. She's mellowed, some, now that Amond's proven himself steady rather than a cautionary tale, but she still calls Marc-Anthony's family "the fancy Bullocks" with a mix of genuine affection and pointed class-consciousness that keeps the show honest about how differently these two best friends grew up.

DESHAWN BAKER

Amond's father, largely absent since Amond was six — reappears periodically, usually when Amond's career is doing well, in a way both of them silently understand and never fully discuss. Not written as a cartoon villain — he's a specific kind of tragic, a man who genuinely loves his son and is genuinely bad at being present for him, which is a more painful combination than outright cruelty. His occasional reappearances are a recurring, low-grade source of tension between Amond and Gloria (she never remarried, never fully forgave him; Amond has complicated, unresolved feelings he mostly buries under work).

DOMINIQUE "NIKKI" BAKER-REYES

Amond's older sister by four years — a labor and delivery nurse in Los Angeles, the one member of the Baker family who never had the slightest interest in the industry and is, as a direct result, the person Amond trusts most completely. She's the family member who can cut through Amond's guardedness in about four seconds flat, the one who still calls him "Bug" (a childhood nickname he's forbidden literally everyone else from using) and gets away with it. Her total disinterest in fame makes her house the one place in Amond's life where nothing is a performance — a grounding presence the audience should feel relieved by every time she's on screen.

THE AVERY FAMILY

Tyrese's people. Because he's the group's outsider-by-profession, his family should feel like the group's outsider-by-culture too — a big, loud, musical Southern family that stands in sharp contrast to the LA industry households surrounding him.

REVEREND EARL AVERY

Tyrese's father — a Baptist minister in Atlanta with a genuinely renowned singing voice of his own, the reason Tyrese can actually sing rather than just perform. Proud of his son in a complicated way: thrilled by the success, quietly uneasy about the industry that came with it, and prone to working both feelings into his sermons in ways the whole congregation has learned to recognize. He and Tyrese have a loving but occasionally strained relationship — Earl wanted Tyrese to stay closer to the church's music program, Tyrese wanted the world, and neither of them has ever fully said out loud how much that choice still sits between them.

CORALEE AVERY

Tyrese's mother — ran the church's youth choir for thirty years and privately takes more credit for half the vocal arrangers in the modern music industry than she'll ever publicly claim. Warm, formidable, the kind of mother who can silence a room with a single look and does so regularly to her famous son whenever he starts believing his own press. She and Reverend Earl are TSU's rare stable, long-married couple among the parents of the core seven — a deliberate contrast to how many of the other family units are fractured, remarried, or absent.

JERICO "JERI" AVERY

Tyrese's younger brother by six years — his road manager, and one of the only people in Tyrese's professional orbit who isn't on payroll because Tyrese felt obligated, he's just genuinely the best person for the job. Sharp, funny, has zero patience for industry nonsense, and functions as Tyrese's reality check the way Amond functions as Marc-Anthony's — a sibling who followed a famous brother into the business but built his own lane inside it rather than living in his shadow.

THE SMILLEY FAMILY

Esther's people. If Marc-Anthony's family is Hollywood royalty and Amond's is working-class LA, the Smilleys need their own distinct flavor: old-money-adjacent East Coast transplant, a family that treats show business as slightly beneath them even while benefiting enormously from Esther's career.

DR. VIVIAN SMILLEY

Esther's mother — a former Broadway performer turned child psychologist, which is exactly as loaded a combination as it sounds for a woman who spent Esther's entire childhood simultaneously managing her career and, professionally, understanding the psychological toll show business takes on kids. She's protective of Esther in a specific, informed way none of the other core seven's parents can match — she knew, clinically, exactly what she was risking by letting her daughter become a child star, and she's spent two decades trying to make sure Esther came out the other side intact. Her relationship with Natasha Bullock (Marc-Anthony's mother/manager) is one of professional respect laced with real philosophical disagreement about how child performers should be raised.

CHARLES SMILLEY III

Esther's father — an entertainment attorney, old-school East Coast, the reason Esther's contracts have always been unusually airtight for a child performer. Reserved, precise, deeply proud of his daughter in a way he shows through diligence rather than warmth — he's the parent who shows love by making sure nobody can ever take advantage of you, not by saying it outright. He was, notably, quietly wary of Marc-Anthony for years before the romance ever started — not because he disliked him, but because he'd watched too many Hollywood "childhood sweetheart" stories end in tabloid disaster, and he needed to be convinced Marc-Anthony was different before he ever gave his blessing.

PHOEBE SMILLEY-ANWAR

Esther's younger sister by five years — went the exact opposite direction from her family's entertainment-adjacent world and became a marine biologist, currently doing fieldwork more often than not reachable by phone. The family's wildcard, genuinely uninterested in fame, the person Esther calls

when she needs to talk to someone who has literally no stake in the industry's opinion of her. Their relationship is defined by a specific, loving distance — long stretches of no contact followed by marathon phone calls that pick up exactly where they left off.

THE CUMMINGS FAMILY

Arianna's people. Since she's the one core-seven member who came up without an industry foothold, her family should be the most industry-removed of the group — ordinary, hardworking, and quietly bewildered by the business their daughter has dedicated her life to.

PATRICIA CUMMINGS

Arianna's mother — an elementary school teacher in Baldwin Hills, the parent in the entire core-seven ensemble with the least patience for show business excuses. She loves her daughter fiercely and has never once fully understood why Arianna chose a career with so little job security when she was clearly smart enough to do almost anything else — a tension that surfaces, gently but persistently, every time Arianna's "almost happened" near-misses come up at family dinner. She's not unsupportive; she's just the family's built-in reality check, the voice reminding Arianna there's a whole world outside industry validation.

WALTER CUMMINGS

Arianna's father — a city bus driver for the LA Metro system for over twenty-five years, steady in a way that shaped Arianna's own quiet resilience. Enormously proud of his daughter without fully following the specifics of her career (he can never quite remember which pilot got cancelled or which festival the indie premiered at, and Arianna finds this more endearing than frustrating). He's the parent most likely to show up unannounced to whatever small showcase or reading she's doing that week, sitting in the back, clapping the loudest regardless of the size of the room.

Death (locked): Dies of a heart attack in July 2013, alone at home, watching news coverage of the THE HOLLOW crisis and worried sick about his daughter in the way he rarely said out loud (scripts/THE_FRAME_2.md, the Frigga analog). Arianna arrives at the hospital too late. His death becomes the emotional spine of THE FRAME's second act and the human standard — real people who knew and loved him, on camera, unfakeable — that ultimately exposes Celeste Marlowe's synthetic-creator technology at the film's climax.

DESMOND CUMMINGS JR.

Arianna's older brother by seven years — a firefighter, the sibling who's spent Arianna's entire career gently needling her about "playing pretend for a living" while being, privately, her single most devoted supporter. He's the one who drives two hours to catch a closing-night performance of something that ran for six people and a critic. Their relationship runs almost entirely on affectionate mutual teasing, which makes the rare moments he drops the act and tells her directly how proud he is land twice as hard.

THE DIVINE FAMILY

Harmony's people. Since she came up through Broadway and formal dance training rather than the child-star pipeline the others share, her family should carry that same disciplined, theater-world texture — a legacy of performers, but stage performers, a notch removed from the film-and-TV world the rest of the core seven grew up in.

CELESTINE DIVINE

Harmony's mother — a former principal dancer with a respected regional ballet company, the source of every ounce of Harmony's exacting perfectionism. Retired from performing due to injury in her mid-30s and transitioned into teaching, which means Harmony grew up literally inside a dance studio, absorbing discipline before she could read. Their relationship is loving but exacting — Celestine's praise has always had to be earned, never given automatically, which shaped Harmony into someone who still, as an adult, has trouble accepting a compliment at face value.

FREDERICK DIVINE

Harmony's father — a Broadway orchestra pit musician (reeds, primarily saxophone and clarinet), the reason Harmony has actual working music-reading literacy that most dancers-turned-actors don't. Easygoing where Celestine is exacting, the parent who balances the household's intensity with genuine warmth. He's the one who taught Harmony to actually enjoy performing rather than just excel at it — a distinction that becomes thematically important once her career shifts from the rigor of dance into the more emotionally exposed work of acting.

AUGUSTINE "GUSSIE" DIVINE

Harmony's twin brother (fraternal, six minutes younger) — never went into performing at all, works as an architect in New York, and is the family member most bewildered by and most protective of his sister's chosen career. Being a twin gives Harmony a relationship no one else in the core seven has — an instinctive, occasionally unsettling closeness where they'll say the same thing at the same moment or call each other at the exact right time without meaning to. Gussie is fiercely private, the opposite of Harmony's public life, and their bond is one of the quieter, more grounding relationships available to draw on across the franchise.

THE CHAPMAN FAMILY

Tyler's people. Since Tyler is the group's connective-tissue floater with a hidden musical ambition, his family should reflect that duality — a household that was never fully show business but was never fully removed from it either, split exactly the way Tyler himself is split between two callings.

ROSALIND CHAPMAN

Tyler's mother — ran a small independent record store in Los Angeles for most of his childhood, the actual origin of his real, private love of music, predating his acting career by years. The record store didn't survive the industry's shift to digital and closed when Tyler was a teenager, a loss he still talks about more than almost anything else in his life — it's the emotional wound underneath his "acting pays better, music is what I love" tension established in his character bio. She's endlessly encouraging of the music specifically, in a way that occasionally makes Tyler feel guilty for not pursuing it harder.

MARVIN CHAPMAN

Tyler's father — worked steadily as a session drummer and, later, a high school band director, the reason Tyler grew up literally surrounded by working musicians rather than industry executives. Practical in a way that shaped Tyler's own "reliable, dependable" professional reputation — Marvin always preached that a working musician is someone who shows up on time and knows the chart, not someone waiting to be discovered, and Tyler absorbed that lesson so thoroughly it became his entire acting career's reputation instead of his music career's.

DELIA CHAPMAN-OSEI

Tyler's younger sister by three years — a session vocalist and songwriter who's quietly building the music career Tyler's always wanted for himself, which is a complicated, mostly-loving source of tension between them. She's not competitive with him, exactly, and he's not resentful of her, exactly — but there's an unspoken thing between them about who got the "safe" career and who got the "real" one, and it surfaces, gently, every time she plays him a new song before anyone else hears it.

FAMILY DYNAMICS AT A GLANCE

Character	Family Flavor	Key Tension
Marc-Anthony	Hollywood dynasty (established)	Living up to three generations of legend
Amond	Working-class LA, single mother	Absent father, class contrast with Marc-Anthony
Tyrese	Southern Baptist, musical, stable marriage	Father's quiet unease with the industry he left the church for
Esther	East Coast old-money-adjacent, psychologically literate	Overprotection born from real professional insight
Arianna	Ordinary, industry-outsider, working-class	Family's loving bewilderment at her career choice
Harmony	Broadway/legacy performer family	Exacting standards, twin-bond intimacy
Tyler	Music-world working family	A closed record store as the emotional root of his divided ambition

Why this matters for the franchise: every core-seven member now has a family unit that either amplifies or productively complicates what's already established about them — Amond's guardedness has a concrete source (an absent father, a protective single mother), Tyler's music/acting divide has a literal childhood wound (the record store), Arianna's resilience is mirrored by an entire family of steady,

unglamorous working people, and Harmony's perfectionism traces directly to a mother who never gave praise for free. None of these families exist just to exist — each one is built to be pulled from directly when a script needs a scene that explains why a founder is the way they are.

Doc status: Open. Extend further (grandparents, cousins, in-laws post-marriage) as specific scripts require them.